



George Ionita

Chief Technology Officer

Mauritius
(registered HQ);
engineering
hubs: Silicon
Valley
HQ

\$15–67M (est.)

Revenue

01 Who You're Meeting

George Ionita — Chief Technology Officer, Sand Technologies.

The company: Private Physical AI vendor with deep emerging-market delivery reach via its ALX talent pipeline; deployed in 18+ countries with a services-heavy, project-based model rather than disclosed SaaS metrics.

What they sell: Symmetri — a real-time “Physical AI” control layer (Sense / Analyze / Act) that models physical assets and networks and can act on them directly, for water, energy, telecom, health and government operators.

02 Where The Company Sits

The category creator framing — “Physical AI” as sensing, modeling and directly acting on infrastructure. Smallest and least capitalized name on this list; its edge is emerging-market reach, not platform scale.

03 What To Pressure-Test

- Headcount down ~6% (6-mo) / ~9% (2-yr) per Simplify tracking, despite a growth narrative
- Revenue concentration in large infrastructure clients, which creates project-delay risk if deployments slip
- Analyst-rated C on Differentiation — crowded field vs. Palantir, C3.ai, Cognite, Bentley, AVEVA

04 GIP Context

GIP: No direct connection found. Sand is privately held with no disclosed GIP investment, and none of Sand's named customers appear on GIP's own portfolio-company list (airports, ports, rail, data centers, water/waste and energy assets).

BlackRock: No equity or ownership connection found. There is a real indirect link worth flagging, though: Sand's flagship water-utilities case study customer, Thames Water, has BlackRock as one of the senior creditor bondholders (alongside Aberdeen...

Others at Sand Technologies: Fred Swaniker (Founder & CEO); Danai Mavunga (Chief Operating Officer); David Bratt (Chief Financial Officer)

www.sandtech.com · [Company LinkedIn](#)

Public professional and company information from the research layer of the GIP vendor tracker, generated September 15, 2026. Figures are as reported by the sources listed on the vendor's white page and are not independently audited. Research goes stale — re-run before external use.